life. His humility mel owed me and helped me discard my aggressive approach. His humility did not consist merely in being modest about his talents or virtues, but in respecting the dignity of al those who worked under him and in recognizing the fact that no one is infal ible, not even the leader. He was an intel ectual giant with a frail constitution; he had a childlike innocence and I always considered him a saint among scientists.

During this period of renaissance at DRDL, an altitude control system and an on-board computer developed by P Banerjee, KV Ramana Sai and their team was almost ready. The success of this effort was very vital for any indigenous missile development programme. Al the same, we had to have a missile to test this important system. After many brainstorming sessions, we decided to improvise a Devil missile to test the system. A Devil missile was dis-assembled, many modifications made, extensive subsystem testing was done and the missile checkout system was reconfigured. After instal ing a make-shift launcher, the modified and extended range Devil missile was fired on 26 June 1984 to flight test the first indigenous Strap-down Inertial Guidance system. The system met al